

LET ME TRY · FREE PRINTABLE

Dough Play: Hand-Strength Activities

Practical life and pre-writing · Ages 3–4

Hand strength and finger control come before neat writing. Dough is the perfect, ₹0 way to build them. Use real atta dough or homemade play dough.

Easy play dough recipe

- ○ 1 cup atta or maida, ½ cup salt, 1 tbsp oil
- ○ Add about ½ cup water slowly, knead until soft
- ○ Optional: a drop of food colour or haldi
- ○ Stores for a week in a closed box

10 dough activities

- ○ Squeeze, squash and poke
- ○ Roll small balls between both palms
- ○ Roll long snakes on the table
- ○ Flatten with a small belan
- ○ Cut with a cookie cutter or steel katori
- ○ Press in buttons, beans or leaves
- ○ Pinch small pieces off
- ○ Make letters with dough snakes
- ○ Count balls into a bowl
- ○ Make real roti or puri with you

Safety

- ○ Keep children away from the stove and tawa.
- ○ Supervise small objects pressed into dough.

Signs of growing hand strength

Rolling smoother balls, pinching smaller pieces, holding the belan with both hands evenly, and lasting longer before getting tired.

SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

Montessori, M. The Discovery of the Child (practical life and the hand).

Free to print and share.